

U.S. Trade Force — a one-page concept (v3)

For the reader: President Donald J. Trump. *Draft. Not sent, shared or published. My own idea, with no tie to any person, party, office or company.*

What it does for America. U.S. Trade Force puts American workers, makers, farmers and ranchers first. I make useful things in U.S. shops, near the people who use them. I run the whole chain myself, from parts to the front door, so the money and the jobs stay here. This fits your stated trade policy: put "American workers, manufacturers, farmers, ranchers, entrepreneurs, and businesses" first (White House, "America First Trade Policy" memo, Jan. 20, 2025). My part is not policy. It is building and moving things here.

The problem. Too much of what people need is made far away. Big, bulky things cost more to ship than to make. Things fail at two gaps: the **first ten yards**, where a thing gets made and leaves the shop door, and the **last ten yards**, where it reaches a person. In the mountain West both gaps are wide. The towns are small and the miles are long.

First Ten Yards (make it here). The first gap is making the thing close to home: a local shop, local parts, and the first mile out the factory door. My RIBBON table system is built to be made in small U.S. shops from a file, so bulky freight stays low.

Last Ten Yards (get it there). The last gap is the trip to the door. My Last Ten Yards plan closes it for people in ten mountain-West states, from a charge-and-dock depot I scouted in Salt Lake County.

The whole chain, top to bottom. I model this on a known way of doing business: Tesla owns much of its own chain and sells cars straight to buyers, online and in its own stores, with no franchised dealer in the middle (Wikipedia, "Tesla US dealership disputes"). I have no tie to Tesla or its people. I just use the same shape:

1. **Raw parts:** bought from U.S. sources where I can. I write down where each one comes from.
2. **U.S. shop / maker (First Ten Yards):** a small shop near the buyer makes the part from my file.
3. **Wholesale / depot:** my depot holds stock, charges and docks, and ships to the region. I am the wholesaler; no middle layer marks up the price.
4. **Last Ten Yards to the door:** I bring it the last few yards to the school, library, venue, farm or ranch.

State Pack (copy it state by state). A State Pack is the same model in one kit per state: a list of local shops, one depot site, and the delivery routes. I start with the ten mountain-West states Last Ten Yards serves, one state at a time.

Space tasking: all 50 states. Satellite tasking means pointing a satellite at a place, at a time you choose, to get a fresh picture of it. It is like ordering a new photo from space instead of using an old one (SkyWatch, "What Is Satellite Tasking?", skywatch.com/what-is-tasking; I have no tie to SkyWatch). I will task satellites to watch and route the chain across all 50 states, State Pack by State Pack: the parts, the shops, the depots and the last ten yards. Fresh pictures help me see what is ready and pick the best route. This is what I mean by "I want to own the sky."

My own moonshot: take it global, starting with Latin America.

What I do first (small and real). One RIBBON table segment, made by one U.S. shop, near where it will be used. One sheet shows where every part came from and what it cost to ship. That sheet proves if "made near the buyer" works. Then I build the first State Pack for Utah.

The first 30 days.

- Week 1: Pick the one segment. Draw up the parts list from my RIBBON PRDs.
- Week 2: Ask [number: Erik to set] U.S. shops for a quote. Measure the depot roof, bays and power.
- Week 3: Choose one shop. Write down the source of each part.
- Week 4: Get the segment made or get a firm date. Start the Utah State Pack. Write one Last Ten Yards post on what I learned.

What backs it up. My Armored drill books can train the workers. My patent claims C1–C6 (docking latch, seam caps, service hub and more) are written but not filed yet.

What I need. [amount: Erik to set] to build the first segment. [shop: Erik to pick] to make it. [place: Erik to pick] for the first test. [hours per week: Erik to set] of my own time. [satellite budget: Erik to set] for space tasking. A patent lawyer's review before I file: [date: Erik to set].

Pinned: I want to own the sky.